

Guidelines for Creating High-Quality PPT Decks

Overall Goal

We are building a diverse, high-quality dataset of PowerPoint (.pptx) decks for business / enterprise use cases to support the training and evaluation of LLM-driven PPT creation. Every deck a designer delivers must be ready to pass QC on the first submission — zero hard violations across all dimensions of the Qualification Gate (Gate A, 30 rules).

Designer Expectations

Deliver professional-quality decks suitable for business / enterprise use cases.

Ensure modern design: clean 16:9 layouts, engaging visuals, and professional styles.

Content must be relevant, structured, and concise — neither overly plain nor cluttered.

All assets (images, icons, fonts) must be free-to-use and copyright-safe.

AI-generated or AI-like files are NOT accepted.

Sanitize the file of any confidential or sensitive information before submission; sensitivity = General.

PowerPoint Guidelines

Deck Structure

Use standardized theme fonts, theme colors, and layout designs for a professional, cohesive experience.

Do not mix multiple templates or styles within a single deck.

Use Case & Domain Distribution ($\pm 2\%$ tolerance)

Cover sales pitches, QBRs, training decks, and other business presentation types.

- Financial Services: 10%
- Healthcare & Life Sciences: 9%
- Technology (Software / Hardware): 9%
- Semiconductors: 9%
- Telecommunications: 9%
- Manufacturing & Industrial / Infrastructure: 9%

- Consumer Goods & Retail: 9%
- Professional Services & Consulting: 9%
- Education: 9%
- Government / Public Sector: 9%
- Media & Entertainment: 9%

Language Distribution

- 95% decks in English
- 5% decks in zh-CN (Simplified Chinese)

Slide Dimensions

- Format: 16:9 Widescreen only (1280 × 720 px). 4:3 is forbidden.
- Content safe area: maximum 1200 px wide, maximum 680 px tall.
- Text blocks: maximum height 540 px ($\approx 75\text{vh}$); width $\leq 15/16$ (93.75%) of slide width; height $\leq 17/18$ (94.4%) of slide height.
- Images: maximum 50% width, 75vh height, or full slide bleed.

Branding Elements

Branding is optional. You may include placeholders for logos, taglines, or other brand-specific content for easy customization.

Design Principles

- **Simplicity:** Maintain a clean and intentional design that highlights key information.
- **Conciseness:** Avoid overcrowding slides with text; prioritize clarity and digestibility.
- **Visual Impact:** Incorporate high-quality, relevant images and graphics. Use visual hierarchy — through size, weight, and alignment — to guide the viewer's attention.
- **Data Visualization:** Prefer native PowerPoint charts (editable data) over static screenshots of tables; use diagrams to simplify complex information.
- **Minimal Animations:** Keep transitions subtle and consistent; avoid flashy or distracting effects.

Content Mix Distribution

- 65% decks dominated by charts and graphs
- 15% decks heavy text (2–3 pages with 300–400 words, or every page with 300–400 words)
- 10% decks with very few charts/tables (1–2 SmartArt/table/chart)
- 10% decks text-only

Slide Page Range Distribution

- 10% decks: 3–5 pages
- 40% decks: 6–10 pages
- 45% decks: 11–20 pages
- 5% decks: 21–50 pages

File Format & Submission

- Save and submit as .pptx, sensitivity = General.
- AI-generated or AI-like files are NOT accepted.
- Sanitize confidential / sensitive content before submission.

Quality Requirements

1. Visual Design

Modern Layouts

- Always use 16:9 aspect ratio for all slides; never use 4:3.

Visually Engaging Slides

- Combine text and visuals; use diagrams, charts, and icons to support key points.
- Prefer charts over raw table screenshots for data visualization.
- Avoid empty pages — a slide with little more than a title — unless it is an intentional section opener, thank-you, or closing.
- Avoid pure-text pages: a wall of paragraphs or bullets with no image, icon, chart, shape, column, or color block to give the eye a landing point.
- Avoid photo-album pages: two or more images placed side by side with no title, caption, data label, or design treatment.

Clean Layers (Mandatory)

- Complex custom diagrams built from multiple shapes must be Grouped together. Do not leave hundreds of loose shapes that form a single visual entity.
- Remove all 'ghost' elements before submission: empty text boxes, invisible shapes, or objects completely off the slide canvas.
- Text boxes must be sized to fully accommodate their text. Text must never overflow its container or the slide boundary.

Consistency

- Apply the same color palette, fonts, and visual style throughout the deck.
- Do not mix multiple templates or styles.

Color & Contrast

- Use professional, high-contrast colors for clarity and accessibility.
- Primary palette evenly distributed across red, yellow, orange, blue, green, gray, and purple. Avoid white as the dominant theme color.

Content Hierarchy & Emphasis

- Keep the content hierarchy on a single slide within 6 levels at most (e.g., title → subtitle → section → sub-section → list item → sub-item). Going deeper than that means the page is carrying more structure than the reader can hold.

- On the same passage, use at most three emphasis devices at once (e.g., Bold, Underline, Color). Stacking more than that is over-design — pick the strongest ones and drop the rest.

Layout Skeleton (No Floating Elements)

- When a slide has 4 or more independent elements, they should sit on at least 2 shared alignment axes. Elements that float between axes read as "off" even when the reader cannot say why.
- Each slide layout should be describable as one of a few common skeletons — grid, Z-pattern, F-pattern, centered, or columns. If the skeleton has no name, the reader cannot read it.
- There must be a clear reading entry point and a clear visual center of gravity. All elements roughly the same size + random spacing + no main subject = floating, not designed.
- Exempt: deliberately free-form layouts (art posters, infographics with connectors and arrows weaving the narrative); pages with 3 or fewer visible elements.

Animations, Transitions & Cartoon Elements

- Keep animations minimal and professional; avoid flashy or distracting effects.
- Up to 5–10% of slides may incorporate cartoon elements or lighter line art aligned with the scenario.

Acceptable cartoon styles (e.g., Corporate Memphis / Alegria) when:

- Shapes are clean and simplified
- Color palettes are professional
- Scenarios are business-relevant
- Proportions are consistent and realistic

Unacceptable:

- Childish, playful, or whimsical aesthetics
- Mascots or decorative characters
- Animals used as characters
- Human figures with exaggerated or unnatural proportions
- Visual styles commonly associated with children's media or casual entertainment

Lighter line art must aid comprehension, never dominate slides, replace essential content, or become purely ornamental. Restraint over repetition.

Tone Matching (Topic ↔ Mood ↔ Audience)

- Match visual formality to topic seriousness. Serious topics (financial annual reports, medical reports, compliance audits) must read formal; do not cartoonify them. Casual topics rendered in rigid bank-grade visuals also read as misaligned.

- Match color temperature to mood. Mourning / solemn topics should not use highly saturated warm colors with high contrast. Celebratory / festive topics should not use cool gray.
- Match visual sophistication to audience. Decks for C-level / board audiences should not read like hand-drawn cartoons; decks for K12 / children should not read like a bank-grade financial report.

2. Content Quality

Logical Structure

- Organize slides with a clear, structured flow.
- The deck must form a coherent story arc (opening → argument → conclusion) such that after one read the reader can restate the core message in a single sentence.

Conciseness & Clarity

- ≤ 8 core content modules per slide. Flowcharts, timelines, and process diagrams: count each sub-node individually. A table is counted as 1 module regardless of rows / columns.
- Single text block ≤ 80 words.
- Each deepest-level bullet item ≤ 40 words.
- Slide title ≤ 15 words and ≤ 3 rendered lines.
- A single informational text block must not exceed 75% of slide height.

Font Sizes

- Core body text (titles, subtitles, paragraphs, bullets, table body, text inside content shapes, primary callouts): ≥ 12pt.
- Secondary annotation text (footers, slide numbers, dates, chart axis / tick / data labels, legends, captions, footnotes, source citations, watermarks, copyright / disclaimer, template branding): ≥ 10pt.
- Applies to all text including chart text, table cells, and text inside shapes.

Text Legibility (Zero Tolerance)

- No text may be obscured by foreground elements or have occluding overlap with background elements — including foreground occlusion, background occlusion, and text-on-text overlap or interleaving across text boxes (even a single character).
- Text must maintain sufficient contrast with its background. No white-on-white, black-on-black, or near-identical hues.
- Do not use symbol fonts (Wingdings, Symbol, Webdings) or heavily stylized fonts that render text unrecognizable.
- Translucent decorative elements (large background numbers, transparent typography) are allowed only if they do not interfere with reading.
- A decorative line, divider, or shape outline must not touch or graze a glyph (including ascenders and descenders). Leave clear space between strokes and letters.

Text Layout

- English words must not be split into two incomplete fragments without a hyphen — this includes both line breaks (e.g., line-end 'implemen' + line-start 'tation') and same-line spurious breaks (e.g., 'Sum mer', 'Col or', 'Par ents').
- A complete word ending one line and another complete word starting the next is normal wrapping and not a violation.
- Hyphenated breaks, and natural wraps of URLs / paths / code / long unspaced strings, are allowed.

Text & Container Breathing Room

- Text must not overflow its container or the slide edge — including bottom overflow (running past the bottom of a card), right-edge overflow (end-of-line words past the right edge), top / left overflow (text origin outside the visible container), rounded-corner clipping (text crossing a corner arc), and decorative shapes too small to fit the text inside them.
- Keep visible breathing room between text and any edge: leave at least about half a lowercase letter of space between text and a container or divider edge, and at least about one uppercase letter of space between text and the slide edge.

Graphics Integration

- All charts and diagrams must be properly labeled and easy to interpret.
- Data, labels, axes, and structural components of charts / tables / diagrams must not be clipped by the slide edge.

Real Semantics (No Placeholders / Dummy Data)

- Content must be meaningful, coherent English (or zh-CN).
- Strictly NO Lorem Ipsum, 'Text here', 'Click to add text', 'Your title here', 'Add your words here', 'Unified fonts make reading more fluent', template variables {{title}}, chart / table placeholder labels, lazy repeated dummy numbers, or similar template copy.
- Use content reflecting modern (post-2020) standards.
- Content must align with its heading and the deck's business intent (e.g., Sales Pitch, QBR).
- Avoid 'Center Everything' on content slides.
- The cover-declared topic must run through the body of the deck, and each slide's title must echo its body. Title and body unrelated to each other means the page reads as an orphan.
- Clean up visual residue before delivery: leftover comments / revision marks, the old logo coexisting with the new one, abrupt style-change pages, meaningless extra decoration, oddly-aligned stray shapes.

Allowed placeholder structures: closing fields (Thank you / Q&A), short structural labels (Step 1, Overview, Closing).

Image Quality

- No pixelation, resolution-driven blur, or visible compression artifacts.
- No proportion distortion (stretched / squashed faces or circular objects are the strongest signal).
- No broken, missing, or empty-frame images.
- No third-party stock watermarks (Shutterstock, Getty, Adobe Stock), social handles, or third-party brand overlays.

Exemptions: presenter / organization's own corner logo watermark; third-party logos appearing as the explicit subject of the slide alongside corresponding brand text; intentional artistic styles (watercolor, flat, low-poly, vector, minimalist line art, retro / film grain).

Element Clipping

- Informational elements (text, chart data, tables, diagrams) must not be clipped by the slide boundary.
- Intentional image bleed is allowed if the primary subject is not substantially cut off and any embedded text / data labels remain intact.
- Purely decorative geometry (background blocks, accent lines) is exempt from clipping rules.

Image Placeholders & Repetition

- No empty image placeholders (border-only, no content).
- No empty device mockups (laptop, phone, monitor, browser frame) showing blank screens.
- No repeating the same content-level image on a single slide. Functional small icons (bullets, social, contact icons) are exempt.

Editability

- No vectorized or otherwise non-editable text (except for text appearing in accompanying images).
- No non-editable infographics, charts or tables.

Font Application

- Do not use Chinese-designed fonts for Western content.
- Do not cross-use fonts between scripts — use Western fonts for Western content and Chinese fonts for Chinese content.

3. Compliance & Standards

Copyright & Licensing

- Use only free-to-use assets (images, fonts, icons, templates).
- Double-check permissions for any external content.

Metadata & File Details

- Provide accurate metadata: title, domain, format, slide count, year.

Business Suitability

- Decks must be appropriate for professional and enterprise contexts.

Topic Red Lines for the Global Market

Anything in the table below will take the deck out of the dataset, no matter how well it is executed visually.

Category	What designers should NOT do	OK to do
Political sensitivity	Party-state system, national leaders, "red culture" themes, sensitive historical events, HK / Macau / Taiwan / frontier issues, war and terrorism, religious conflict, geopolitical confrontation, human-rights / racial controversy, China national-defense education.	Generic government / public-sector business decks (procurement, infrastructure, public service delivery) that stay clear of the items on the left.
China-specific festivals & memorials	Spring Festival, Mid-Autumn, Dragon Boat, Qingming, the 24 Solar Terms, Chinese zodiac, National Day, CCP / PLA founding days, Martyrs Day, National Memorial Day.	Global / Western calendar events (New Year, Christmas, Thanksgiving) used in corporate communication.
China education & ideological instruction	K12 subject courseware (PEP / Bushi / BNU / Sujiao + grade markers), ideology & politics courses, Mao Studies / Marxism School, civil-servant exams (Xingce / Shenlun / Xuandiao).	HR (social insurance, household registration), legal advice, recruitment JDs, CPA / Bar / Legal Professional / Teacher Certification — legitimate local business tracks.
Map content	Any rendered map (world / continental / national / provincial / administrative / geographical-distribution infographics). Sovereignty-disputed regions (South China Sea Islands, Nine-Dash Line, Diaoyu, Kashmir, Golan Heights, Dokdo) — zero tolerance.	Non-cartographic geographic context — city skylines, regional photography, numeric tables with country names — when no map graphic is rendered.
Time-outdated content	COVID-19 era references (PCR test, Health Code, Fangcang, pandemic control). Obsolete China policies (three-child / two-child / Double Reduction).	Current, in-force regulations and contemporary business context (post-2020).
Illegal & gray-area marketing	Gambling, tobacco promotion, pornography, glorified violence, drugs, hate speech, MLM, WeChat-business scripts, gray finance, "success cult"	Legitimate financial services, regulated wellness, evidence-based personal development presented in professional

	brainwashing, false promises.	tone.
Chinese traditional culture & local-only themes	Guofeng / Chinese style, ink wash, calligraphy, Peking opera, Confucianism-Buddhism-Daoism, Forbidden City, Great Wall; TCM and health regimens; ethnic-minority culture; left-behind children, Spring travel rush, anti-fraud campaigns, earthquake-disaster prevention, Chinese-style annual gala awards.	Modern Chinese business and consumer themes — fintech, EV, e-commerce, retail — presented in a contemporary global visual language.

No Local Chinese / East Asian Aesthetic Styles

This rule is about visual STYLE, not subject matter. What is forbidden is delivering the deck IN a distinctly local Chinese or traditional East Asian aesthetic style.

- Do not deliver the deck in a "中国风 / 古风" style — including ink-wash painting aesthetics, brush calligraphy as primary typography, traditional Chinese decorative borders, traditional auspicious motifs as the dominant visual language, or layouts modeled on classical Chinese scroll / 卷轴 compositions.
- Do not deliver the deck in a Japanese / Korean traditional aesthetic style either (e.g., ukiyo-e illustration style, seigaiha pattern as primary motif, traditional shrine / temple architectural framing as the layout language).
- Modern, internationally readable visual languages (modern Western design, minimalist flat, neutral corporate, modern editorial, modern data-visualization style) are the default for this dataset.

Quality Checklist Before Submission

- ✓ Modern 16:9 layout, 1280×720
- ✓ Consistent color, font, and style throughout
- ✓ Clear flow and structure
- ✓ Balanced visuals and text
- ✓ Font sizes meet thresholds (core ≥12pt, secondary ≥10pt)
- ✓ ≤ 8 modules per slide; text block ≤ 100 words; bullets ≤ 40 words; title ≤ 15 words / 3 lines
- ✓ No text obscured, overflowing its container, or overflowing the slide
- ✓ No mid-word splits (within line or across line); no placeholder copy
- ✓ All images sharp, undistorted, free of third-party watermarks
- ✓ No copyright violations
- ✓ No 'ghost' objects or empty text boxes
- ✓ Complex diagrams are Grouped
- ✓ Accurate metadata
- ✓ Chinese fonts for Chinese text, Western fonts for Western text — no cross-use

- ✓ No empty / pure-text / photo-album pages
- ✓ Content hierarchy per slide ≤ 6 levels; emphasis devices per passage ≤ 3
- ✓ Slides with 4+ elements sit on at least 2 alignment axes; layout matches a named skeleton (grid / Z / F / centered / columns)
- ✓ Text keeps visible breathing room from container edges, dividers, and the slide edge
- ✓ Tone matches: topic seriousness $\leftrightarrow$ visual formality / mood $\leftrightarrow$ color / audience seniority $\leftrightarrow$ visual sophistication
- ✓ Topic clear of Global red lines (politics / China-only festivals / education-ideology / maps / time-outdated / illegal-gray / Chinese-only culture)
- ✓ No local Chinese / East Asian aesthetic styles (no 中国风 / 古风 / ink-wash / brush-calligraphy / ukiyo-e style as the deck's visual language)

Things to Avoid

- ✗ Slides that are too plain or text-heavy
- ✗ Repetitive or unchanged layouts across slides
- ✗ Placeholder text that is not real copy
- ✗ Inconsistent color palettes or fonts
- ✗ Overly complex or cluttered charts
- ✗ Flashy or non-professional animations
- ✗ Outdated templates or 4:3 ratio
- ✗ Copyrighted images, icons, or fonts without proper licensing
- ✗ Elements with third-party watermarks
- ✗ Text overflowing its container or the slide boundary
- ✗ Text-on-text overlap or any text occlusion
- ✗ Empty image placeholders, blank device mockups, repeated filler images
- ✗ Undersized fonts (core $< 12\text{pt}$, secondary $< 10\text{pt}$)
- ✗ Distorted images (especially faces)
- ✗ Childish cartoons, animal characters, exaggerated figures
- ✗ AI-generated or AI-like files
- ✗ Non-editable texts / infographics / tables / charts
- ✗ Empty / pure-text / photo-album pages
- ✗ Single slide carrying more than 6 content hierarchy levels; same passage stacking more than 3 emphasis devices
- ✗ 4+ elements with no shared alignment axes — elements floating with no named layout
- ✗ Text pressed against container edges, dividers, or the slide edge
- ✗ Decorative line or shape stroke touching or grazing a glyph
- ✗ Tone mismatched: cartoon on serious topics; cool-gray on celebratory topics; hand-drawn cartoons on C-level decks
- ✗ Same title pasted across multiple slides; cover topic unrelated to body; uncleared revision marks or stale logos
- ✗ The deck delivered in a 中国风 / 古风 / traditional East Asian aesthetic style

Examples of Good Practices

- Clean, modern themes with clear hierarchy and concise text.
- Well-integrated icons, diagrams, or flowcharts.
- Effective color-coding for sections.